

RICARDO MARTINS SANTOS

Lisbon, Portugal

Email: ricardo.martins@gmail.com

Phone: +351 916 447 823

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/ricardo-martins-santos](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ricardo-martins-santos)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Staff Engineer with 6 years of hands-on experience building scalable backend systems and leading technical initiatives across fintech and SaaS environments. I spend most of my time designing distributed systems, mentoring engineers, and solving the kinds of infrastructure problems that keep services running reliably at scale. I'm driven by clean code and pragmatic solutions that actually work in production.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer - Backend Infrastructure

FinFlow Systems, Lisbon, Portugal

www.finflowsystems.io

January 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a microservices architecture that reduced deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes, enabling the team to ship features faster without sacrificing stability.

Led the migration of legacy monolithic payment processing system to event-driven architecture, resulting in 99.95% uptime and handling 3x concurrent transaction volume.

Mentored 4 junior and mid-level engineers on system design principles, code review practices, and production debugging techniques through weekly technical sessions.

Established observability standards across 12 services using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to detection for critical issues from 20 minutes to 3 minutes.

Senior Backend Engineer - Platform Team

DataVault Solutions, Porto, Portugal

www.datavault.co

June 2019 - December 2021

Architected and deployed a real-time data synchronization service processing 500 million events daily using Kafka and PostgreSQL, serving 150+ enterprise customers.

Improved API response times by 60% through database query optimization and strategic caching implementation with Redis across the platform.

Owned the on-call rotation for critical infrastructure and established runbooks that reduced incident resolution time by 35% across the organization.

Implemented comprehensive API rate limiting and authentication system that protected the platform from abuse while maintaining seamless experience for legitimate users.

Backend Engineer

TechStart Ventures, Lisbon, Portugal

www.techstartventures.net

March 2018 - May 2019

Built core REST APIs in Python handling user authentication, data management, and third-party integrations for a consumer-facing SaaS platform.

Optimized database indexes and SQL queries that improved homepage load times from 2.8 seconds to 650 milliseconds for 200k daily active users.

Contributed to infrastructure-as-code initiatives using Terraform, managing AWS resources across development, staging, and production environments.

Participated in architectural decisions that shaped the platform's technical direction and ensured code quality through peer reviews and testing practices.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science

Instituto Superior Tecnico, Universidade de Lisboa, Lisbon, Portugal

Graduated: June 2018

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, JavaScript

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, SQS), Google Cloud Platform

Messaging Systems: Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Technologies: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Git

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

System Design: Distributed Systems, Microservices Architecture, Event-Driven Systems